



2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

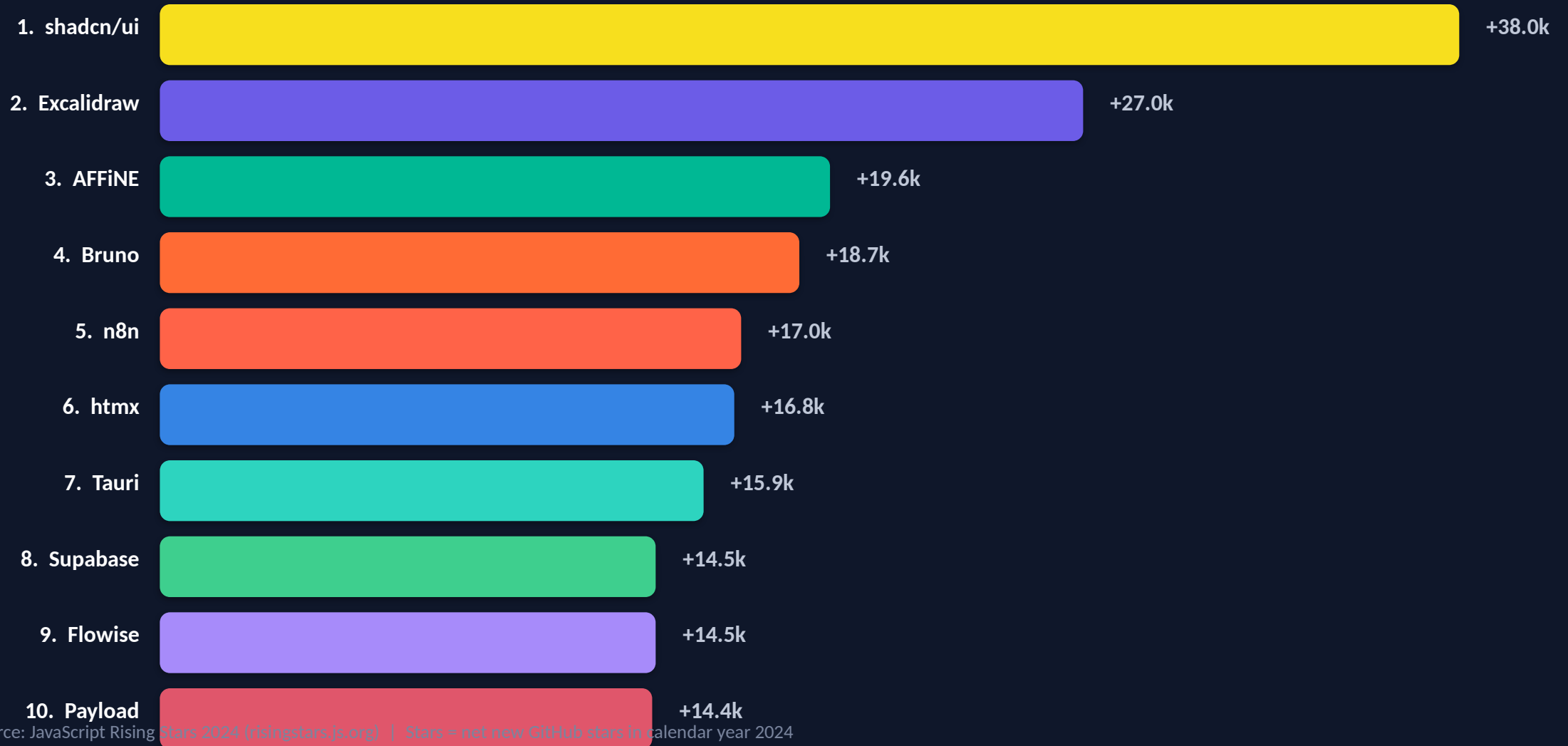
The Year's Hottest Projects by GitHub Stars

9th Edition | Methodology: GitHub stars added in 2024 from the Best of JS curated list

For frontend engineers & engineering managers tracking JS ecosystem trends

Overall Top 10: shadcn/ui Leads with +38k Stars

GitHub stars added in 2024 | Most-starred JavaScript projects overall



shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Year

Year-over-Year Star Growth



Key 2024 Additions

- Charts — powered by Recharts
- Themes — CSS variable generation
- Blocks — layout collections for web apps
- Responsive Sidebar component
- Upgraded CLI — Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos

Component Ownership Model

- Developers copy & paste components into their own codebase — full ownership, no version-lock.
- Spawned derivative ecosystem: Motion-Primitives, Magic UI, and more.

Registry Ecosystem

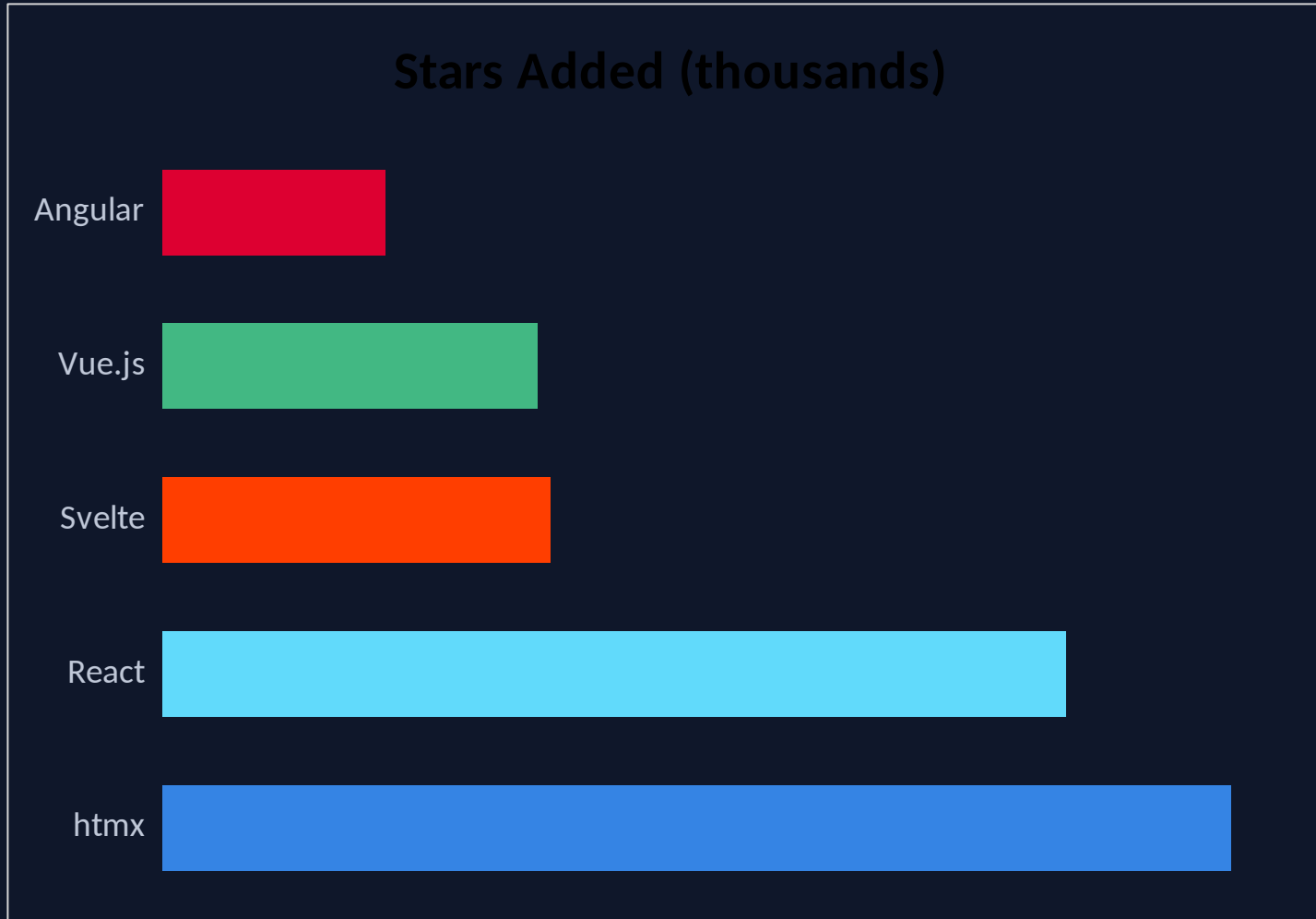
- CLI supports importing from any compatible registry.
- Multi-framework: Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos.

AI Integration

- Integration with Vercel's v0 for AI-generated components further boosted adoption.
- AI + component ownership = rapid prototyping pipeline.

htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework

Stars added in 2024 — front-end frameworks category



htmx: HTML-First

- Rose from #2 in 2023 to #1 in 2024.
- Extends HTML with `hx-*` attributes for data fetching & interactivity.
- Zero JavaScript required — ideal for server-driven apps.

React 19: Framework Spec

- Launched December after 3 years of development.
- Server Components, Server Functions, new hooks, form actions.
- Evolving from library to "specification for frameworks."
- Svelte 5 introduced runes — highest positive opinion in State of JS.

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate

1

shadcn/ui

+38.0k

Beautifully designed copy-paste components

2

Excalidraw

+27.0k

Virtual whiteboard for hand-drawn diagrams

3

Payload

+14.4k

Open-source fullstack Next.js framework

4

Magic UI

+13.2k

Animated UI components for design engineers

5

Next.js

+12.1k

The React framework for production

React's Evolution: Library → Framework Specification

- With Server Components and Server Functions in React 19, multiple frameworks (Next.js, Remix) now interpret React's primitives differently.
- React is becoming more of a specification than a standalone library — a shift toward a framework-first mindset.
- The React Compiler continues development to improve performance and developer experience.
- Client-only usage remains possible, but the ecosystem is gravitating toward full-stack frameworks.

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead



Vue 3.5 Reactivity Overhaul

- Reworked reactivity system with lighter alien-signals approach already in main branch.
- Significant performance improvements and smaller bundle size.
- Daniel Roe (Nuxt lead) highlights active release cycle.

UI Library Ecosystem Confidence

- PrimeVue, shadcn-vue, and other libraries signal growing ecosystem maturity.
- Vue component model enables high-quality derivative libraries.

The flourishing of Vue UI libraries signals a confident, maturing ecosystem — developers are investing in building for Vue at scale.

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser Innovation Shape 2024

AI-Powered Projects

n8n +17.0k

Workflow automation with native AI

Flowise +14.5k

Visual drag & drop LLM flow builder

Supabase +14.5k

Open-source backend with AI capabilities

AFFiNE +19.6k

Knowledge base with AI integration

Desktop & Mobile

Tauri +15.9k

Lightweight desktop/mobile apps with web frontend

Browser Innovation

PGlite

Postgres via WebAssembly in the browser

WebVM

Full virtual machine running entirely in-browser

4 of the top 10 overall projects have significant AI capabilities — AI integration is now table stakes.

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

1 Component Ownership Beats Imports

shadcn/ui's model of letting developers own and customize component code proved its staying power for a second year, reaching 77.5k total stars.

2 HTML-First Is Serious

htmx overtook React as the #1 front-end framework by stars added, validating server-driven, low-JavaScript architectures.

3 React Is Becoming a Framework Spec

With Server Components and Server Functions, multiple frameworks now interpret React's primitives differently — it's evolving from library to specification.

4 AI Integration Is Table Stakes

Four of the top 10 projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have significant AI capabilities or integrations.

5 Vue's Ecosystem Maturity

A wave of high-quality UI libraries and the Vue 3.5 reactivity overhaul signal a confident, maturing Vue ecosystem heading into 2025.

Looking ahead to 2025: Watch for AI-native frameworks, continued HTML-first adoption, and React's framework spec crystallizing across the ecosystem.